

AWAKENED RELATIONSHIPS

A CORE COMPETENCY OF UNCONDITIONAL LOVE



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Purpose, Vision and Mission Statement

Our Purpose: Clarity for the benefit of all.

Our Vision: Living a joyful life free of judgment and fear.

Our Mission: To transform the world through unconditional love and simplicity. We work in partnership and collaboration, providing training through our Awakened Relationships and Natural Leadership programs.

In Radical Love, we share our six Guiding Principles in everyday life, in our organization, on our website, through social media, classes, coaching, special events and a community of like-minded people.

Our culture is transparent and congruent. We live our work. We are committed to sharing clarity with open-hearted kindness and fierce compassion.

Our Guiding Principles are the content of our work.

- Personal Response-Ability
- Sharing Direct Experience
- Knowing Ourselves
- Honoring Our Word
- Being Authentic
- Applying Skillful Means

In Radical Love, each moment is an opportunity to live open-heartedly for the benefit of all.



Love becomes a path of awakening, of rousing us from the sleep and trance states of old unconscious, conditioned patterns into the freshness and immediacy of living more fully. This is the path of Awakened Relationships.

~ Judith Orloff and Melissa Stuart, Co-Founders, Radical Love Foundation

What is an Awakened Relationship?

We are both “authentic” and “awake,” yet the space between being awake and being authentic is vast. Authentic means genuine, of undisputed origin, accurate and reliable. Awake means to be aware of something for the first time, to become conscious, to stop sleeping, to realize, and be mindful.

An authentic relationship is when we can depend on someone to be who we know them to be. We are not surprised at their response to what comes their way. We are not even surprised by what comes our way. We can feel comfort knowing how each of us will respond to being interrupted, making a mistake, the sensation of touch, religion, politics and new perspectives.

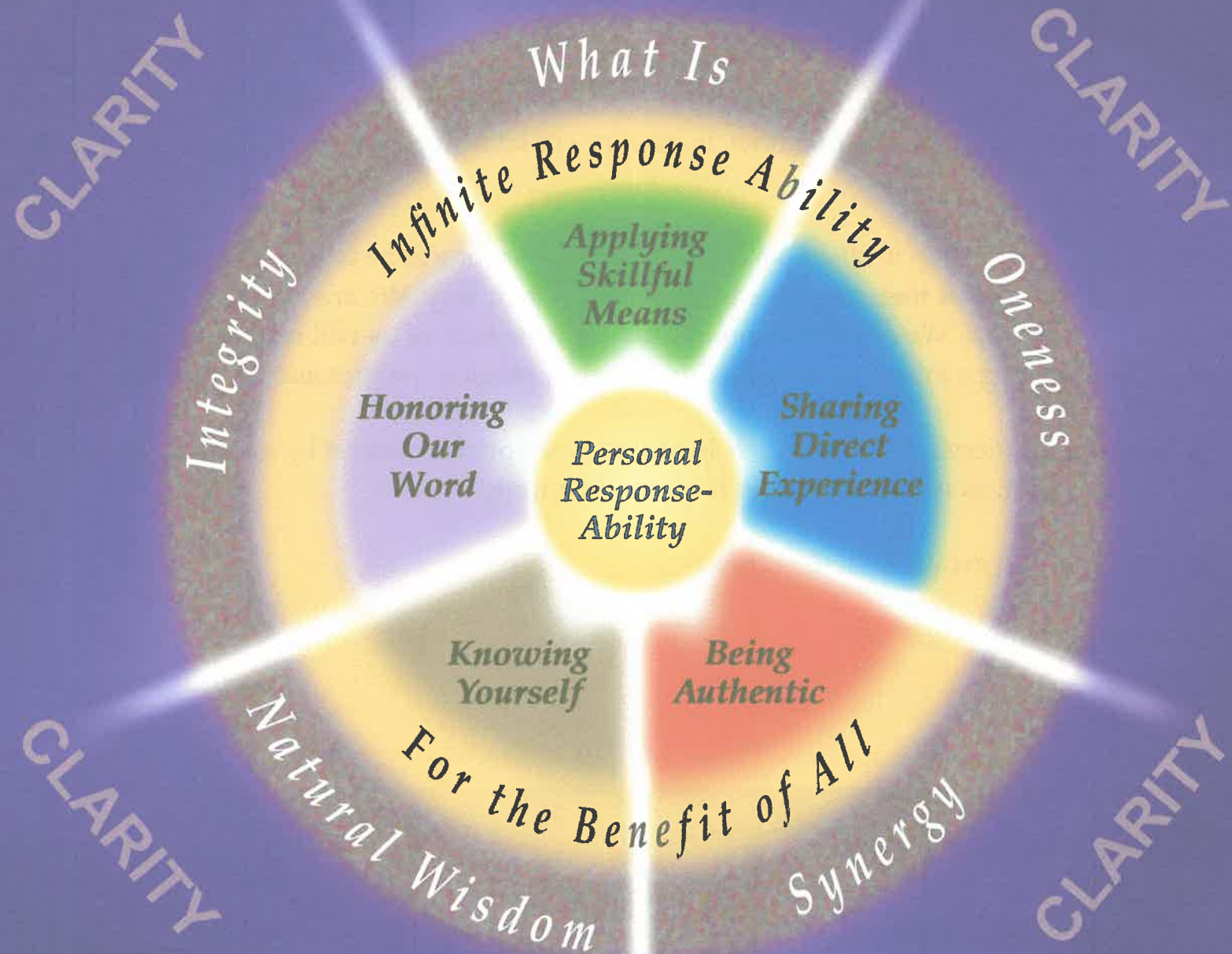
An awakened relationship can and does bring many surprises moment by moment. We cannot know what is next, as we are seeing “as if for the first time.”

Both authentic and awake exist simultaneously.

Why not experience both?



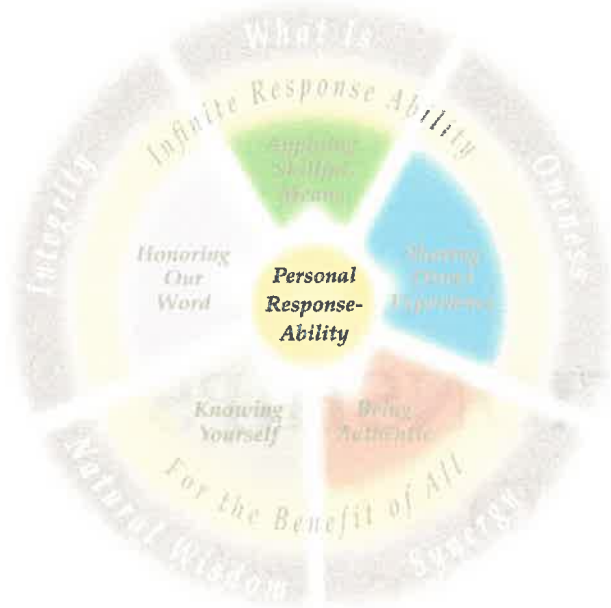
AWAKENED RELATIONSHIPS: A CORE COMPETENCY OF UNCONDITIONAL LOVE



AWAKENED RELATIONSHIPS

A CORE COMPETENCY OF UNCONDITIONAL LOVE





Notes and Reflections

Guiding Principle #1 – Personal Response-Ability

Being personally responsible (response-able) means mastering the ability to respond to each situation, each moment, with unlimited options, always for the benefit of all.

We Are Our Results: We Are Response-Able

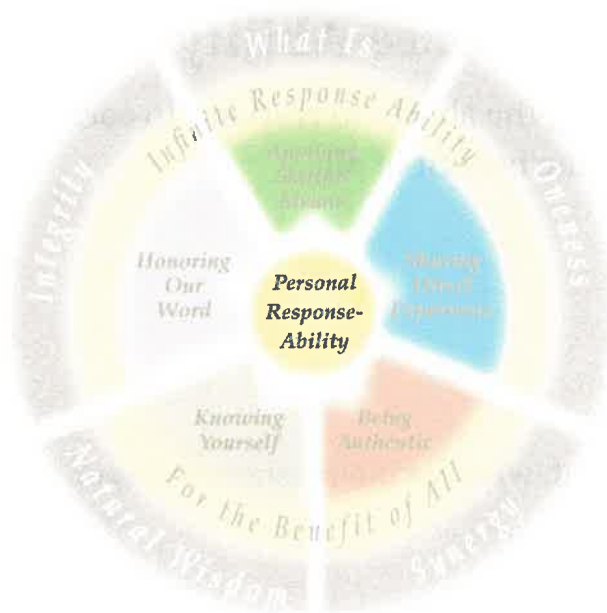
We are not separate from our results.

- We are already awake
- Reality = “What is”
- Being in the present moment gives us nothing to think about, whereas interpretations flavor and color our experience
- Our responses are unique and reflect our conditioning
- Options are unlimited
- Actions are for the benefit of all

Benefits

- Gratitude
- We experience the world as we experience ourselves
- Contributing fully
- Open-hearted behavior





Notes and Reflections

Personal Response-Ability

Seeing Possibilities: All Points of View Arise and Resolve in Clarity

When we live in a world of right and wrong, or good and bad, our life will continue just as it is now. See all points of view as equal. Experiencing all points of view enlivens us.

- All that we see is our point of view
- All points of view are equal as they originate from clarity
- Sharing our points of view gives access to clarity

Benefits

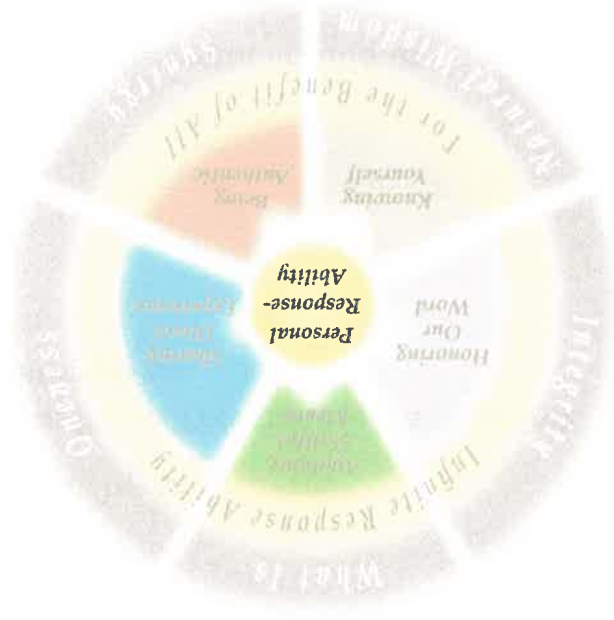
- Each moment is an opportunity for discovery of ourselves and the world around us
- Intimacy with oneness

When we forget our vision, it is easy to believe our fears are true.

~ Radical Love Fieldbook



Notes and Reflections



Personal Response-Ability

Transparency and Harmony: No Separation

When our feelings, expression and behavior match, we are congruent.

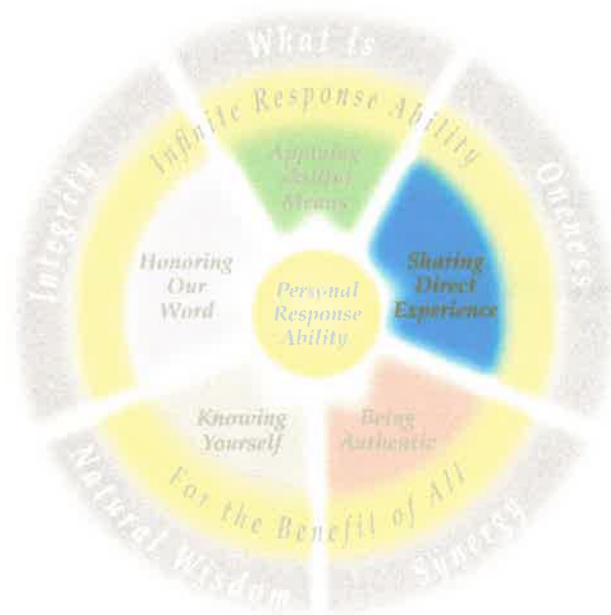
- When congruent, there is no separation between ourselves and others
- We naturally share what is arising in the moment
- We feel everything and do not conform to pretense

Benefits

- Vitality
- Natural seeing of “What is”
- Unimpaired sensory perception

**The result in mastering the competency of
Personal Response-Ability is trust in life itself.**





Notes and Reflections

Guiding Principle #2 – Sharing Direct Experience

Language constructs the details of experience. Honesty, plus intimacy, about our experience, informed by clarity, is what allows for transformation. Giving and receiving feedback with “good purpose” means sharing your direct experience with nothing added or withheld. This is a direct path into clarity and connection.

Listening and Receiving: Our Body is the Receiver of Our Experience

Our bodies are the receiver of our experience; our minds are the deceiver. With radical listening you receive the history and potential futures of the communication.

- Be informed and guided by the sensations in your body
- There is no experience without sensation
- Feelings are sensations
- Be willing to feel your feelings
- Feelings not experienced persist and control us
- Feelings can dissolve conditioning

Benefits

- Freedom from reactivity
- Spontaneity
- Sensing and feeling the whole
- Equanimity





Notes and Reflections

Sharing Direct Experience

Opportunity for Transformation: Direct Experience

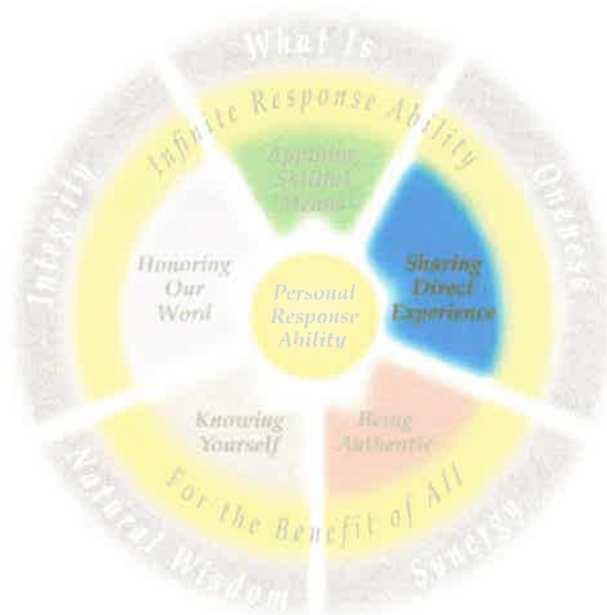
The moment we choose a new behavior and a new interpretation, our conditioning evolves. Those around us usually do not respond in the same way.

- “What is” right here, right now
- There is no effort involved, it’s effortless
- When we share about ourselves, there is nothing to argue with

Benefits

- Clarity
- Originality
- Simplicity
- Listening and speaking for the benefit of all





Notes and Reflections

*All relationships are the mirrors for us to face and understand ourselves
more rapidly and profoundly than any other aspect of worldly life.
Radical Intimacy paves the way to Awakened Relationships.*

~ Radical Love Fieldbook

Sharing Direct Experience

Without Reason: Radical Intimacy

When we defend, justify or explain, we believe we are convincing someone (including ourselves) of the truth of our perspective.

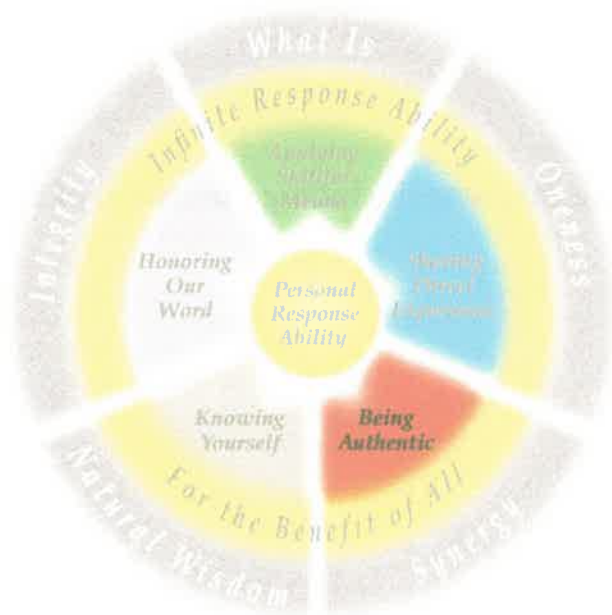
- Sharing direct experience
- Seeing and feeling deeply

Benefits

- Natural connection
- Open-hearted relationships
- Speaking the unspeakable
- Freedom to share our inherent talents and gifts

**The result of mastering the competency of
Sharing Direct Experience is oneness.**





Notes and Reflections

Guiding Principle #3 – Being Authentic

Authenticity is undisputed credibility and genuineness. We view ourselves and others as unique and equal.

Communicating without Pretense: Fierce Compassion

We are already open. Being this openness is all that is required. Our actions arise from clarity.

- Seeing through reactive states
- Sharing the simple truth of our direct experience
- Allowing clarity to inform our behavior
- Standing our ground

Benefits

- Widening the river of experience
- Deep understanding
- Peace





Notes and Reflections

Being Authentic

Trust and Equality: Living in Partnership

We are equal in creating our partnerships. Our interpretation of circumstance is conditioned. Put your trust in clarity and enjoy the benefit of having nothing to think about.

- Turning towards the other
- Giving what you are asking for
- Receiving the whole of communication
- Mutually sharing direct experience

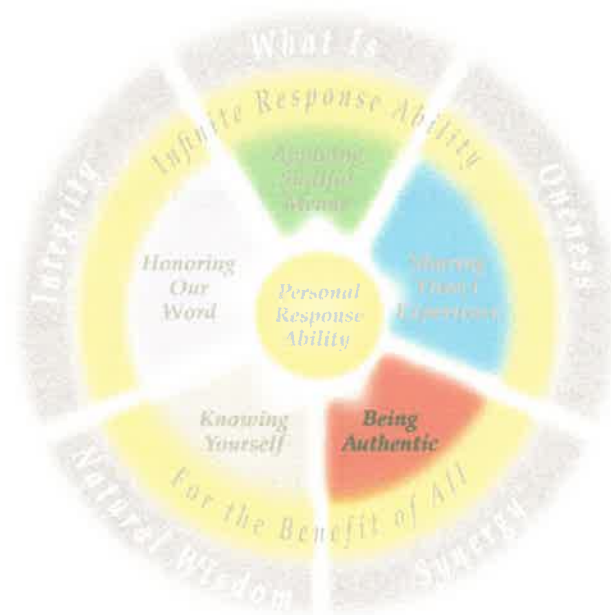
Benefits

- Friendship
- Collaboration and support
- Generosity

Be willing to be with each other right here, right now, without agenda, precondition, or attachment to an outcome. It becomes more important to stay present, than it does to have your way.

~ Melissa Stuart, Co-Founder, Radical Love Foundation





Notes and Reflections

Being Authentic

Our True Nature is Always for the Benefit of All: Interdependence

When clarity informs our behavior there are no sides. There is natural balance. We are interdependent. Effort and struggle dissolves.

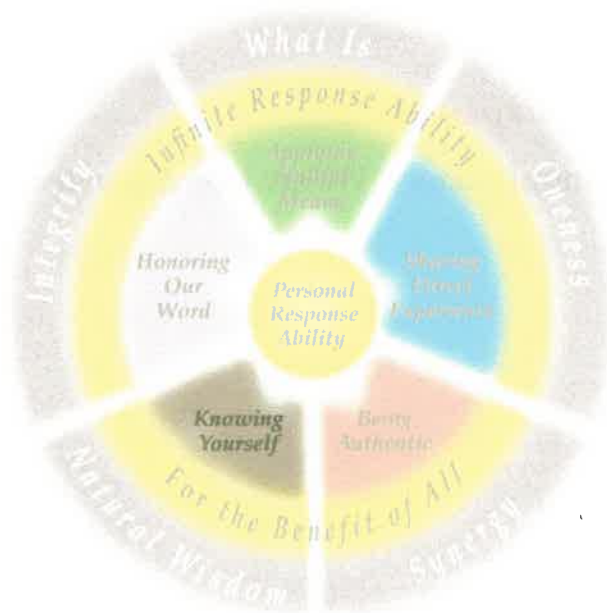
- Sharing of direct experience
- Responding to the true needs of others
- We are responsible for our collective evolution

Benefits

- Relationships are informed by clarity
- Awareness of the consequences of our actions locally and globally
- Infinite responsibility

**The result in mastering the competency of
Being Authentic is freedom.**





Notes and Reflections

Guiding Principle #4 – Knowing Yourself

Knowing our self and our points of view allows us to walk in the world without fear of loss and the need to control our environment.

Understanding Our True Nature: Being Human

Although we can only point to that “Which is,” our relationship with clarity guides us to our true nature. Our true nature is only and always for the benefit of all.

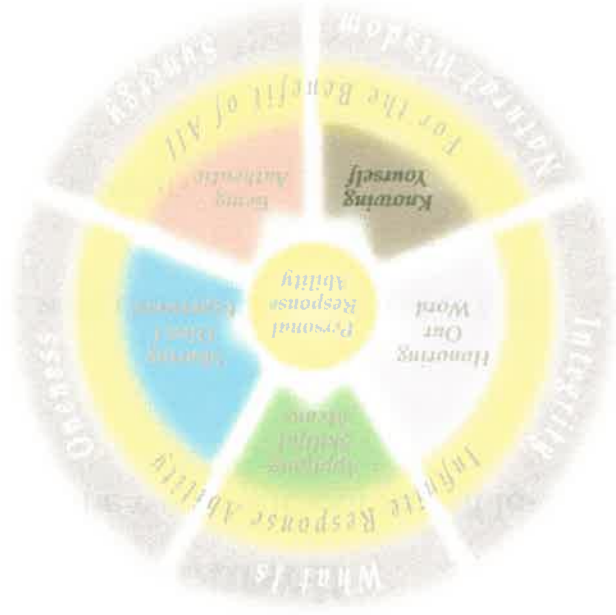
- We are all unique in our expression, while the same in our humanity
- We are equal in our emotional capability
- We are all equally conditioned, yet not conditioned equally
- We are life

Benefits

- Authentic self-expression
- Fearlessness in relationship
- Appreciation of our human nature
- Our attitude toward life itself is open and clear



Notes and Reflections



Knowing Yourself

Assuming Innocence: Seeing through Conditioning

Even if another person is behaving in a hurtful manner, it is not personal to us. It is how they were taught to express themselves. How we respond is how we were taught to express ourselves.

- Our conditioned patterns are rooted in our family history and our culture
- When we are informed by clarity, our patterns dissolve
- Having the full experience of our feelings evolves our conditioning
- As our conditioning evolves, so do our morals and ethics

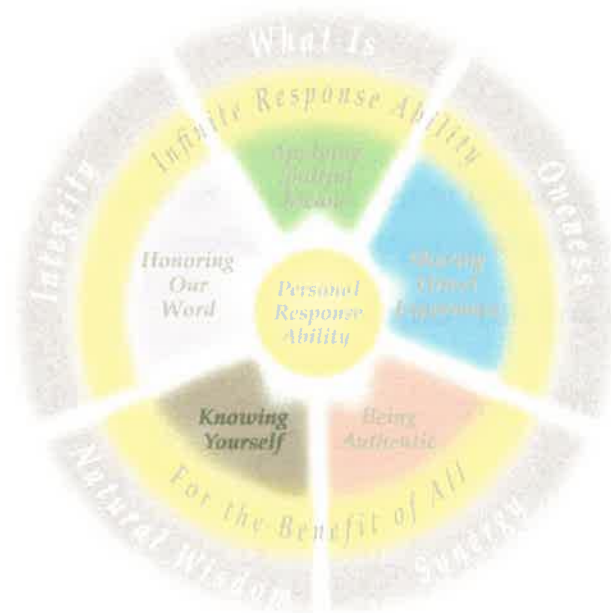
Benefits

- Living joyfully
- Open-hearted compassion
- Closeness and intimacy in everyday life

In the midst of uncertainty, we can know truth.

~ Judith Orloff





Notes and Reflections

Knowing Yourself

Living Our Life Purpose: Wellbeing

Using our natural gifts and talents, for the benefit of all.

- When we're caring for ourselves, we're caring for everyone
- Experience everyone as they are, without interpretation
- Use skillful means in all situations

Benefits

- Healthy, authentic living
- Natural curiosity
- Living a beneficial life

**The result in mastering the competency of
Knowing Yourself is natural wisdom,
natural authority and natural ethics.**





Notes and Reflections

Guiding Principle #5 – Honoring Our Word

Honor and keep our word.

Keeping Our Word: Integrity-based Relationship

Keeping our word is radical integrity.

- Keeping our word is simply doing what we say, no matter how we feel
- If we are unable to keep our word, we honor our word by communicating any change as soon as possible and making sure the other people are whole
- Our natural confidence is strengthened by keeping our word

Benefits

- Integrity
- Flexibility
- Clear mind
- Being complete and whole





Notes and Reflections

Honoring Our Word

Communication in Relationship: Everyday Clarity

We are already in relationship with everyone we meet. We are free to respond for the benefit of all.

- Seeing the natural flow of all points of view and perspectives
- Allowing things to be as they are
- Assumptions and reasons dissolve upon inquiry
- One step at a time

Benefits

- Self-respect
- Natural wisdom
- Common sense

You maximize the opportunity for success if you honor your word. Honoring your word is privately optimal in the sense that it requires no cooperation from anyone else. Even if everyone else is out of integrity, it is in your best interest to be a man or woman of integrity.

~ Werner Erhard





Notes and Reflections

Honoring Our Word

Free Choice: The Good of the Whole

When we make a free choice, it includes the consideration of all points of view, is made without conditions, and is for the good of the whole.

- Consider all options
- Experience all points of view
- No perspective is independent
- All points of view arise in clarity, for the benefit of all

Benefits

- Natural morals and ethics
- Being authentic in relationship
- Radical humility

**The result in mastering the competency of
Honoring Our Word is peace of mind.**





Notes and Reflections

Guiding Principle #6 – Applying Skillful Means

Skillful Means allow us to know what actions to take in all situations. Skillful Means point to truth, and are extremely flexible and contradictory. Each moment, situation and person is unique. Only when relying on clarity can we use Skillful Means. Clarity points us to what makes sense in each moment with each situation.

Opening Our Heart and Mind: Being Vulnerable

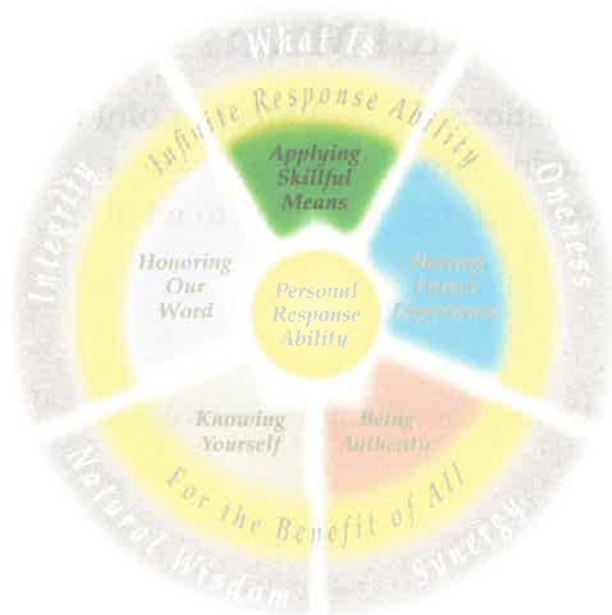
The safety of vulnerability gives us the courage to open our heart and mind. Being vulnerable is the gateway to freedom.

- Having the courage to be seen and known by others
- Vulnerability in all situations is our greatest strength
- Experience all sensations and feelings

Benefits

- Living joyfully
- Fulfillment
- Unlimited access to creativity
- Endless unfolding of our innate intelligence





Notes and Reflections

Applying Skillful Means

Seeing through Our Reactions: Reactions are Goldmines

Reactions are the cultural adaptation to our true feelings. Reactions were a creative survival strategy when we were children. Reactions in the present moment are illusions that we believe are true. Fully feeling our feelings lifts the veil of illusion, freeing us to respond.

- Reactions are goldmines – feelings are the gold
- Reactions cover our deepest hurts and fears
- In reaction we are victims to circumstance
- When we experience our hurts and fears our reactions disappear
- Sharing our direct experience provides simple access to our true nature

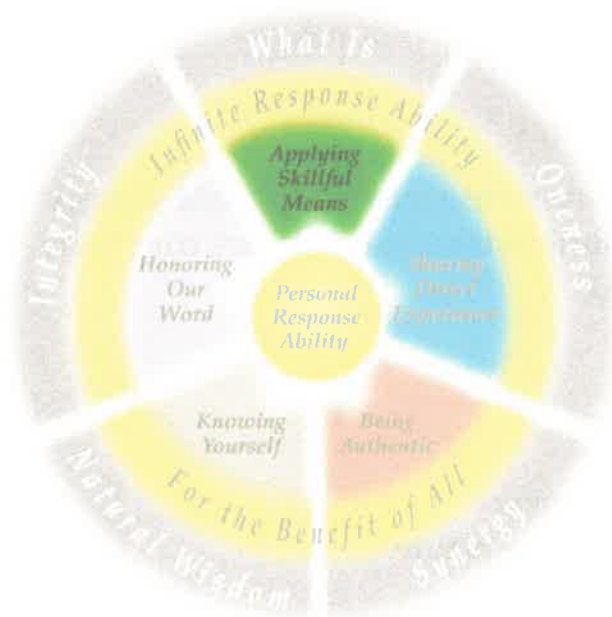
Benefits

- Thinning our habitual conditioning
- Eliminating the reactive perspective of “either/or”
- Being in wonder and natural wisdom

*Using Skillful Means profoundly connects the core of our being with another,
and directly recognizes oneness in relationship.*

~ Radical Love Fieldbook





Notes and Reflections

Applying Skillful Means

Thinning Our Conditioning: Expressing Our Humanity

There is nothing in our past that cannot be dissolved. There is no behavior that cannot be transformed, no behavior that cannot be changed. We just have to want this change more than we desire comfort, no matter how uncomfortable we feel.

- We are only “one”
- Whatever we see is “us”
- Whatever we give and receive is “us”
- Be with “What is” rather than attempting to change anyone or anything
- Experience the wholeness of giving and receiving, always for the benefit of all

Benefits

- Seeing the obvious
- Unity

The result in mastering the competency of Skillful Means is knowing each person is whole.



Awakened Relationships: A Core Competency of Unconditional Love

For the Benefit of All

Our individual capacity to love and be kind to ourselves is fundamental to our sense of joy, happiness and wellbeing. Because we are not ultimately separate, our direct experience tells us that we cannot love ourselves, unless everyone we touch experiences benefit in their interaction with us. “For the benefit of all” directs our evolution and maturation as an individual and a species.

Infinite Responsibility

Infinite Responsibility is response-ability without boundaries or limitations. As an individual I am personally response-able each moment of my life. As unique life itself, that which I think, feel, believe and offer to the world is my infinite responsibility towards the next moment that nothing else can equal.



For the Benefit of All unites us with all living beings.

~ Judith Orloff and Melissa Stuart,
Co-Founders, Radical Love Foundation

